

DAVID CRABTREE

PhD Student, Dept of Political Science
University of Chicago

Research: Deterring Democratic Backsliding, Comparative Institutions

EDUCATION

University of Chicago

PhD Student, Dept of Political Science

MA, Social Sciences

2023

MA Thesis: “Chronological Sequences of Backsliding in Presidential Democracies”

MA Advisor: Tom Ginsburg

East Tennessee State University

BA, Political Science

2022

BA, International Affairs

Distinguished Honors (click for link)

PUBLICATIONS

“Can Unamendable Term Limits Prevent Presidents-For-Life?” *Democratization*

<https://doi.org/10.1080/13510347.2025.2534695>

WORKING PAPERS

“Formal Change in International Organizations: How Amendment Rules Matter” (with Tom Ginsburg and Kristina Daugirdas)

“Charters of International Organizations: Evidence From a New Dataset” (with Tom Ginsburg, Kristina Daugirdas, and Morgen Miller)

PROFESSIONAL RESEARCH

Project Manager, *Charters of Intergovernmental Organizations*

2024

Funded by National Science Foundation — Hosted by American Bar Foundation

PIs: Tom Ginsburg, University of Chicago; Kristina Daugirdas, University of Michigan

- I manage a team of 10 RAs who collect and code documents detailing how each IO makes decisions and which countries are part of each IO.
- I write R scripts to integrate and clean incoming data.
- I collaborate with web developers to host our original corpus of IO legal documents online.

RESEARCH ASSISTANTSHIPS

Tom Ginsburg, Unamendable Term Limits, University of Chicago

2023

Read hundreds of national constitutions housed in the Comparative Constitutions Project to hand-code a global dataset of unamendable term limit provisions; generated descriptive statistics in R

Monika Nalepa, Transitional Justice Lab, University of Chicago *2023*
Examined trends in physical repression for democratizing countries pre-transition by building graphics in R with cross-sectional time-series data

Wesley Wehde, Welfare Attitude Survey, East Tennessee State University *2022*
Used Qualtrics to program a survey experiment estimating the effect of information regarding federal COVID-19 relief programs on social welfare attitudes. Used R to generate descriptive statistics, graphics, and calculate average treatment effects for manuscripts

PRESENTATIONS

Nov 14, 2024. “Can Unamendable Term Limits Prevent Presidents-For-Life?” Northeastern Political Science Association Conference. Boston, MA.

TEACHING ASSISTANTSHIPS

Instructional Assistant (full time), Dept. of Political Science, University of Chicago
Honors Thesis Preceptor (Patricia Conley, AY 2023-2024; 2024-2025)
Political Science Research Methods (Patricia Conley, Fall 2024)
Electoral Politics in America (John Mark Hansen, Fall 2024)
Introduction to Comparative Politics (Michael Albertus & Benjamin Lessing, Fall 2023)
Introduction to American Politics (Ruth Bloch Rubin, x2 Winter 2024; x3 Winter 2025)
Introduction to International Relations (Paul Poast, Spring 2024; x3 Spring 2025)
Global Studies I (Callie Maidhof, Fall 2022; separate TA-ship)

PUBLICATIONS (UNDERGRAD)

“Examining Policy Feedback Effects from COVID-19 on Social Welfare Support: Developing an Outcome Distance Dimension.” (With Wesley Wehde), *Policy and Politics*. (2023).

“Who Deserves What and Why During the COVID-19 Pandemic: Applying the CARIN principles of deservingness to the American welfare state.” (With Wesley Wehde), *Social Policy and Administration*. (2022).

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

Maroon Scholar Research Scholarship, University of Chicago *2022*
1/2 MA Tuition

Graduate Fellowship, Phi Kappa Phi National Honors Society *2022*
\$8,500 for research proposal studying democratic institutions

Summer Research Fellowship, Honors College at East Tennessee State University *2021*
\$3,500 for survey research on COVID-19’s impact on political attitudes

President’s Academic Performance Scholarship, East Tennessee State University *2019*
Highest undergraduate merit-based scholarship

SKILLS

Programming Languages and Technical Frameworks

R, L^AT_EX, GitHub, Qualtrics, Stata

Languages

Spanish